Motherboard Component Explorer

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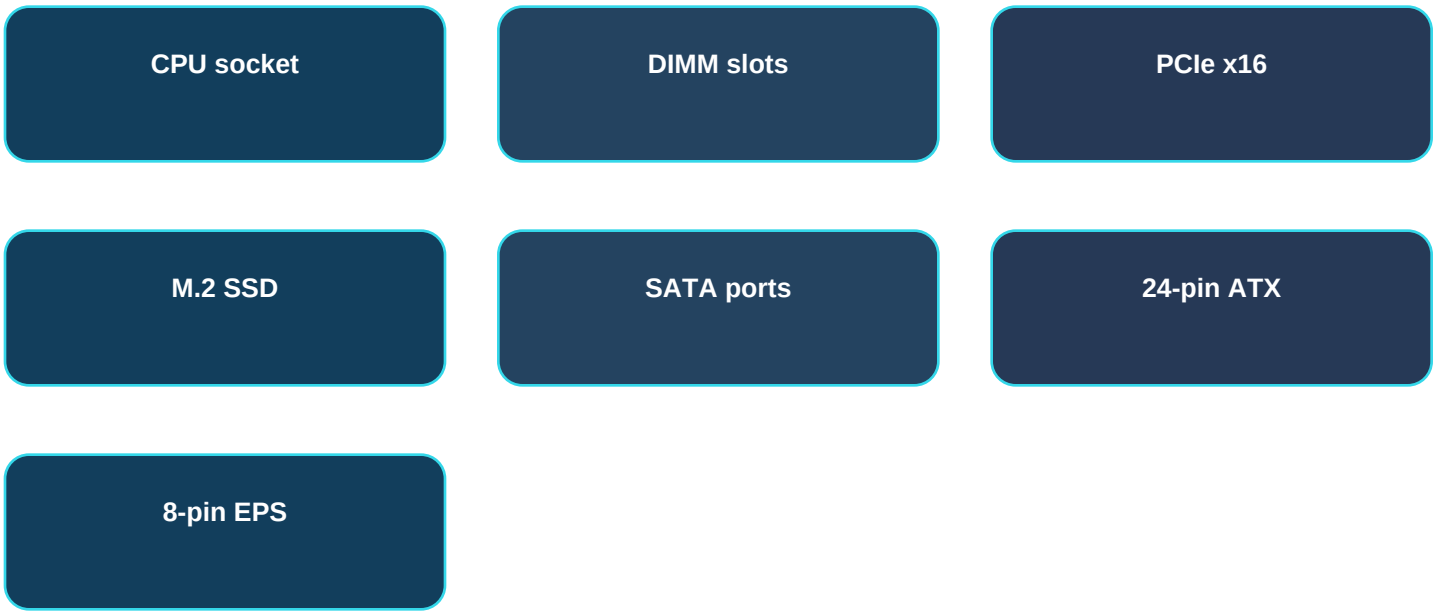
Visual Reference - System Components / Workflow



Preparation Checklist

- Power off, unplug, and discharge static before handling components.
- Identify the socket, RAM banks, expansion slots, and power headers.
- Check motherboard manual for supported CPU, RAM, PCIe, M.2 keying, and cabling.
- Never force a CPU, DIMM, or power connector into a mismatched socket.

Training reference diagram; not a vendor-specific photograph or configuration screenshot.

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Vocabulary and Technical Reference

CPU socket
Receives the processor and provides physical contact.

DIMM slots
Accept system memory modules; align notches.

Chipset
Coordinates platform I/O functions.

PCIe slots
Connect expansion cards such as graphics or NICs.

M.2 socket
Holds compatible NVMe or SATA SSD modules.

SATA connector
Connects SATA storage using data cable.

24-pin ATX
Main motherboard power connection.

CPU EPS power
Auxiliary power for the CPU power stages.

Review and Troubleshooting

[ ] What observable evidence confirms the objective was completed?

[ ] What two common configuration or hardware errors could cause failure?

[ ] Which tool, indicator, or command would you check first?

Student: _____ Date: _____